BUILDER, STEP 16

Same fact, 4 setups. Only 2 knew it in the next session.

Our test of auto memory and a wiki that Claude Code writes itself.

OUR TEST

Tell it once. Ask in a new session.

SETUP	NEW SESSION
Auto memory on	Knew it. 6 seconds
Auto memory off	Did not know
Wiki, edit not approved	Did not know
Wiki, with a yes	Knew it. 8 seconds

The fact: Sarah wants every invoice in Dutch, sent to finance@example.com, not to her. It was in no file. Made-up client, one run per setup.

TWO KINDS OF MEMORY

You write CLAUDE.md. Claude writes auto memory.

```
~/.claude/projects/<project>/memory/
  MEMORY.md    # the index, 1 line per memory
  example-logistics-invoicing.md

Why: Sarah's own request (2026-10-28).
```

Anthropic: auto memory "is on by default in local sessions". The first 200 lines or 25KB of MEMORY.md load in every session.

Type /memory to see what it saved.

THE TRAP

A "remember this" can be lost.

- → Our house rules said: the wiki is the knowledge base.
- → So Claude wanted to write the fact in the wiki, not in its own memory.
- → In manual mode, Claude asks before each edit. Nobody said yes.
- → Nothing was saved. The next session did not know.

After "remember this", read the answer. If it asks, say yes.

THE WIKI

Karpathy's idea: Claude writes the wiki, you read it.

LAYER	IN OUR TEST
Raw notes	16 made-up client notes. Never changed
Wiki	9 files: a page per client, 3 topics, index.md, log.md
Rules	A 19-line CLAUDE.md

The price changed from EUR 1,850 to EUR 1,950. The wiki put both prices with their dates under "Current state", and two offers under "Not agreed".

Build: 72 seconds, one time.

THE HONEST RESULT

With 16 notes, you do not need a wiki yet.

QUESTION	NO WIKI	WIKI
The agreed price	22 s, 10 s	**6 s, 9 s**
No October check	18 s, 16 s	**12 s, 10 s**

2 runs each. All 8 answers were right. The wiki was a few seconds faster.

Karpathy: it "works surprisingly well at moderate scale (~100 sources, ~hundreds of pages)".

Start with auto memory. Add the wiki when your notes grow.

MY OWN SETUP

My second brain, in plain files.

	MY OWN CLAUDE CODE
Memory index	106 lines, under the 200-line limit
Topic files	258
Wiki notes	2,362, since 23 May
Every night	At 04:30, a job turns the day's logs into wiki notes

The lesson: a date does not retire an old fact. Replace it, and keep the old one under "History".

FREE FILES

Get the cheat sheet and the wiki rules. Free.

→ Auto memory and the wiki, side by side

→ The 19-line CLAUDE.md for the wiki

→ Templates for the index and a page

→ 16 made-up client notes, to test on

On my profile, under Featured: AI Starter Kit, step 16.
Save this post.

Tomorrow: GitHub, your real undo button.